

SQL

MBUA 512

Class 3 – SQL

SQL = Structured Query Language, "es-queue-el" or "sequel". With Michael Winikoff.

Recap from last week (database design):

1. Data modelling using diagrams
2. Translating diagrams to relational databases, and the role of *keys*
3. Anomalies, and avoiding them by *normalisation*

Based on slides by Professor Markus Luczak-Roesch.

SQL commands

- `CREATE TABLE` and `ALTER TABLE` - define the structure of a table (its *schema*)
- `INSERT INTO` and `DELETE FROM` and `UPDATE` - change the data in the table
- `SELECT` - query data

(there are a lot more than these)

Important: make sure you select `MySQL` (not `Trino`) and your own workspace
(`user_[username]`)

CREATE TABLE

```
CREATE TABLE name (  
    column_name data_type,  
    column_name data_type,  
    ...  
)
```

Data types

- Integer / Int — 12 , -14
- Varchar(length) — a string, 'Hello!' (variable-length characters; use single quotes)
- Real — 3.14 , -9.8345 (floating point, inexact)
- Decimal — 3.29 (exact, up to 38 digits)
- Varbinary — binary data
- Date — DATE '2026-12-31' (year-month-day, with the optional word DATE)
- Time — TIME '01:58:36.77' (with the optional word TIME ; also a time-with-time-zone)

CREATE TABLE – example (note KEY)

```
CREATE TABLE people (  
    personID INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,  
    firstName VARCHAR(30) NOT NULL,  
    lastName VARCHAR(30),  
    birthdate DATE NOT NULL,  
    planner INTEGER,  
    email VARCHAR(30),  
    FOREIGN KEY(planner) REFERENCES people(personID)  
);
```

ALTER TABLE

`ALTER TABLE` changes the definition of an existing table.

```
ALTER TABLE name ADD COLUMN column_name data_type
```

```
ALTER TABLE countries ADD COLUMN continent VARCHAR
```

INSERT INTO

```
INSERT INTO table_name (columns...) VALUES (vals...), ...
```

Single quotes are for strings, **double quotes** for database objects.

```
INSERT INTO people VALUES
    (1, 'Bob', 'Smith', '1917-01-03', 1, NULL),
    (2, 'Bob', 'Smith', '1973-03-25', NULL, 'bob@smith.net'),
    (3, 'Alice', 'Smith', '2026-07-07', 1, 'Alice@smith.net');
```

the (columns...) is optional

Importing from a CSV

To generate rows from a CSV: ask an LLM, or use a spreadsheet with a few formulae (next slide).

Prompt: "Convert the following CSV into an SQL statement to insert the data into an ANSI database"

Using a spreadsheet

- use `= " ' " & A2 & " ' "` to convert each string cell into a quoted string
- use `= " ( " & TEXTJOIN( " , " , FALSE , D2 : F2 ) & " ) , " "` to join cells into a single row
- put `INSERT INTO people VALUES` in the first row
- copy and paste the rows
- demo ...

DELETE FROM table

```
DELETE FROM table WHERE conditions
```

Leaving out the WHERE deletes **all** rows!

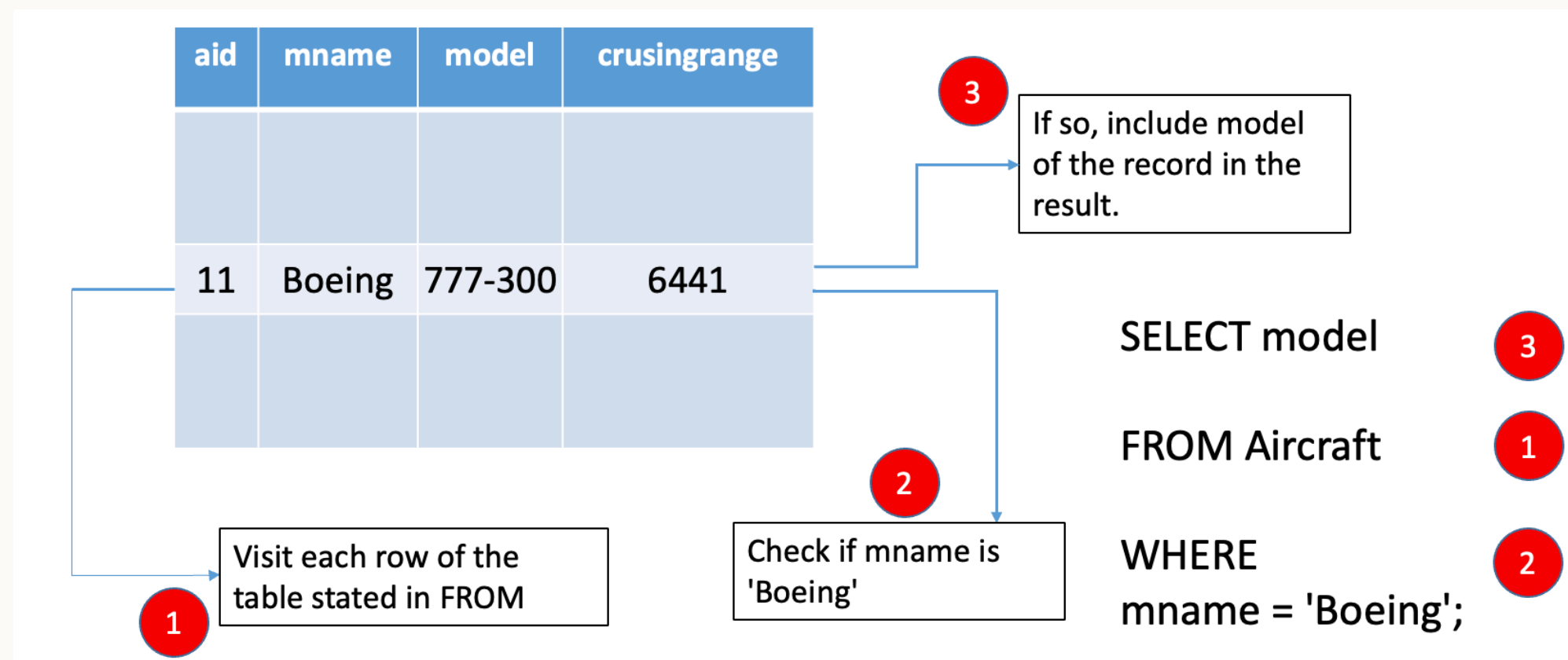
SELECT

```
SELECT what
FROM   table(s)
WHERE  conditions

-- "--" starts a comment to the end of the line
/* and this is a
   multi line comment */
SELECT *           -- "*" means "everything"
FROM   people
WHERE  email is NULL
```

By far the most complex – basics today, more next week.

How does SELECT work?



SELECT with multiple tables – joins

```
SELECT * FROM people p1, people p2
```

Need a *join condition*

```
SELECT p1.firstName AS birthday,  
p2.firstName as 'party planner' FROM  
people p1, people p2 WHERE  
p1.planner=p2.personID
```

A SQL query goes into a bar,
walks up to two tables and asks...

“Can I join you?”

Summary

- `CREATE TABLE` and `ALTER TABLE` – define the structure of a table (its *schema*)
- `INSERT INTO`, `DELETE FROM`, `UPDATE` – change the data in the table
- `SELECT` – query data

Next: activities in part 2 today – learn by doing. Next week, more SQL, focusing on `SELECT`.

Class 4 – more SQL

- SELECT calculations (next slide) - and DISTINCT
- WHERE conditions (next next slide)
- ORDER BY (DESC)
- GROUP BY, and aggregates (min, max, avg, count, sum)
- LIMIT n

How to write SQL queries & tips

Other things(?): Transactions?

(for now in the class 3 file - will separate out later)

SELECT calculations

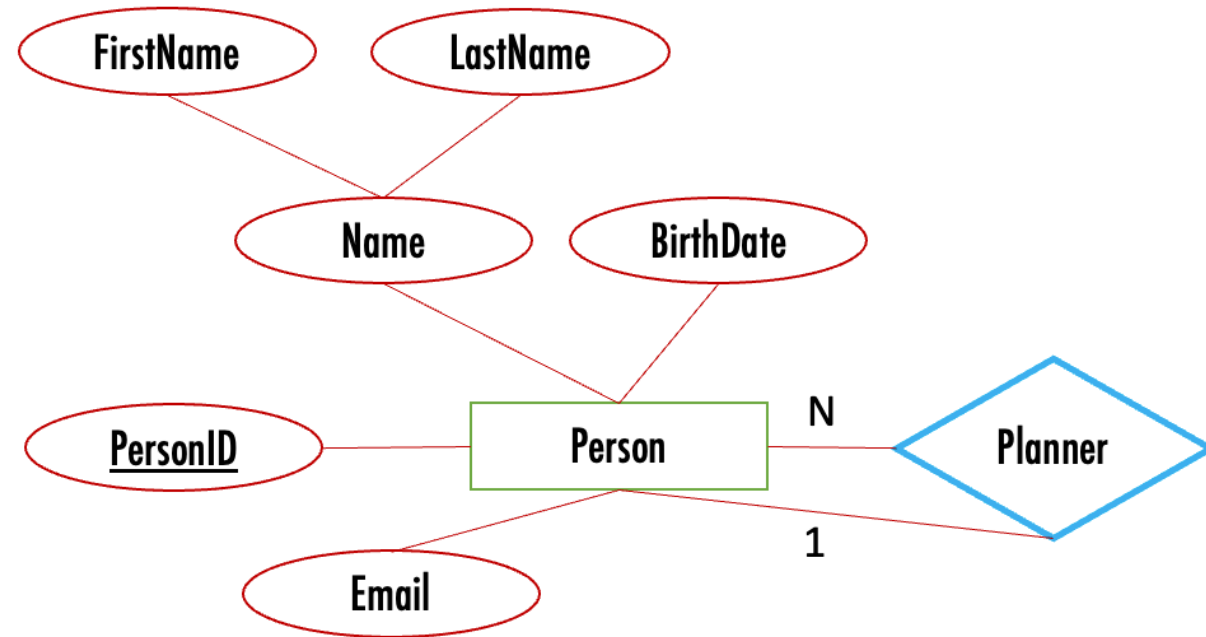
- string ||
- AS
- numerical operations including floor, ceiling, round
- date operations - including current date, subtraction

WHERE conditions

- IS NULL
- IN
- LIKE and %_
- numerical conditions
- date conditions
- logical operators (AND, OR, NOT)
- (not) EXISTS
- UNION, INTERSECT

Running Example: birthday

- Scenario: send a message to people on their birthday, and remind their designated party planner to plan a party earlier
- Data: name (first, last), birthdate, email address, and designated party planner



To create the database

```
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS people;

CREATE TABLE people (
    personID INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
    firstName VARCHAR(30) NOT NULL,
    lastName VARCHAR(30),
    birthdate DATE NOT NULL,
    planner INTEGER,
    email VARCHAR(30),
    FOREIGN KEY(planner) REFERENCES people(personID)
);
```

To add data

```
INSERT INTO people VALUES
    (1, 'Bob', 'Smith', '1917-01-03', 1, NULL),
    (2, 'Bob', 'Smith', '1973-03-25', NULL, 'bob@smith.net'),
    (3, 'Alice', 'Smith', '2026-07-07', 1, 'Alice@smith.net'),
    (4, 'sam', 'Smith', '2020-01-03', 1, 'sam'),
    (5, 'Bobbie', 'Smithton', '1987-03-16', NULL, 'bob@smith.net');
```

Some queries to write (1/2)

1. Find people whose birthday is today so we can email them (combine first and last names)
2. Find people with a special birthday (e.g. 100) coming up (hint: need to calculate age, use FLOOR)
3. Find people with a birthday in January, February or March so we can email their planner (hint: use IN)

Some queries to write (2/2)

administrative tasks:

4. Find people with missing or invalid email addresses (hint: use NULL AND ... NOT LIKE)
5. Find where two (or more) people have the same email address (hint: use EXISTS)
6. Find people who are not planners for anyone else and do not have a birthday (hint: use EXISTS)

analysis task:

7. how many people have a birthday in each month? (hint: use GROUP BY and EXTRACT(MONTH from ...))

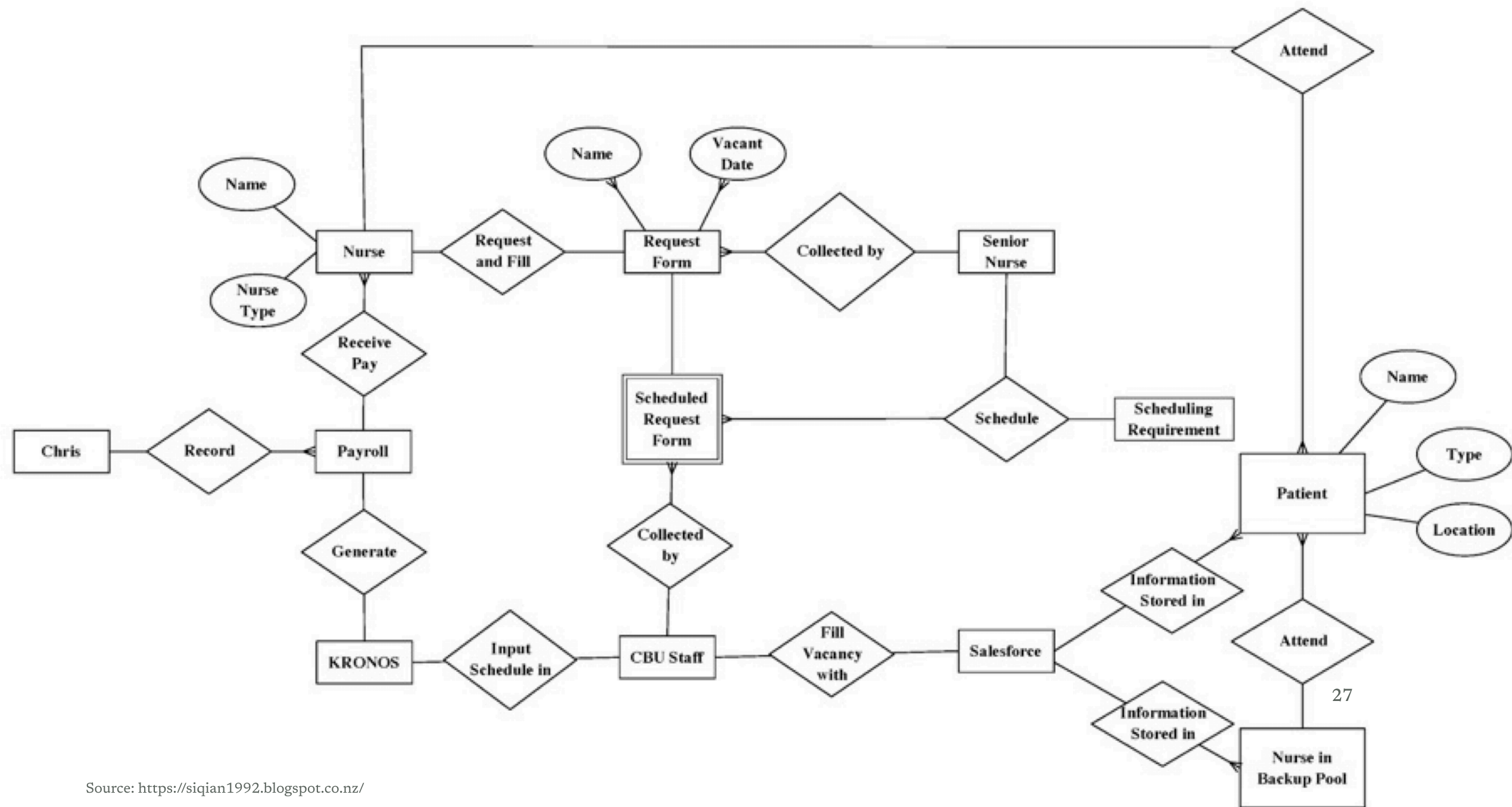
Tips for writing SQL

- Build it up in pieces, testing each piece (* can be useful)
- Think about:
 - What information you need to see in the result (which columns ...) ... values?
Calculations? Aggregate calculations (e.g. SUM)?
 - What tables they come from
 - How you need to JOIN the tables
 - What constraints to use ... and how to express them
 - WHERE if based on row
 - WHERE ... AND exists – if not

More tips

- `' '` (single quotes), not `" "` (double quote)
- Distinct – the whole row needs to be distinct, so sometimes select fewer columns
- Group By ... Having ... - the "Having" goes just after the "Group By ..."
- NULL is not the same as the empty string
- Too many rows in result? Check JOIN conditions (or using "NATURAL JOIN" - which is not the same as "JOIN")
- No rows in result? Check conditions, and perhaps remove some
- Using exists – make sure there is also an "AS ..." (so can refer to parent query in sub-query)

Summary



Some useful Superset commands (MOVE OR DELETE)

```
show schemas from idrive
show tables in idrive.relbench_rel_ratebeer  -- most tables
show tables in idrive.relbench_rel_avito
select * from idrive.relbench_rel_ratebeer.countries
```

Select schema `user_[username]` , replacing `[username]` with your username
(e.g. for me, `user_michaelwinikoff`).

Activities

Some possible activities for class 3

- CREATE a DB
- DB content:
 - Add content - including from CSV?
 - Delete content
 - Update content
- Explore constraints
- Simple (one table) SELECT
- Joins

Some possible activities for class 4

- to complete

Activity – ...

~ 10 minutes, in groups